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Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave

Educational and synthetic policy corpus. Northstar Technologies Inc. is a fictional company created for an AI engineering project. All people, records, email addresses, examples, and operational data are synthetic. These documents are not legal advice and do not replace applicable law, benefit plan documents, signed employment agreements, or case-specific guidance from People Operations.

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Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees requesting or using statutory, medical, caregiving, bereavement, civic, or personal leave
Classification	Internal

LEV-1. Purpose

This policy provides a common process for absences that are not ordinary vacation, including statutory, medical, wellness, caregiving, parental, bereavement, civic, emergency, and personal leave. Leave rights vary by location and circumstances. Northstar will apply the greater protection required by applicable law or a written agreement.

LEV-2. No loss of legal rights

Nothing in this policy limits a legally protected leave, accommodation, workers' compensation right, military or civic obligation, or other mandatory entitlement. Employees should contact People Operations because the correct classification affects pay, benefits, documentation, job protection, and records.

LEV-3. Paid wellness leave

RFT employees receive 80 hours of paid wellness leave each calendar year. RPT employees receive a prorated amount equal to 80 hours multiplied by scheduled weekly hours divided by 40, rounded to the nearest hour. Greater statutory paid-sick entitlement is provided when required.

Wellness leave may be used for the employee's illness, injury, medical appointment, preventive care, mental-health need, or qualifying care of a family or household member. It is separate from PTO, does not carry over, and is not paid out at separation unless law requires otherwise.

Employees should notify the manager before the scheduled start time when reasonably possible and provide an expected duration. Employees do not need to disclose a diagnosis to the manager.

LEV-4. Medical and disability leave

An employee who cannot work or needs intermittent time because of a medical condition should contact People Operations. People Operations will assess statutory leave, disability benefits, workplace accommodation, reduced schedule, and return-to-work requirements.

For an absence of more than three consecutive scheduled workdays, or when there is a reasonable pattern or safety need, Northstar may request appropriate documentation of functional limitations, expected duration, and ability to work. A diagnosis is requested only when necessary and lawful. Medical records are stored separately with restricted access.

LEV-5. Family, caregiving, parental, and statutory leave

Eligible employees may take family-responsibility, caregiving, pregnancy, parental, adoption, domestic-violence, military, public-health, or other statutory leave when the legal criteria are met. Duration, pay, notice, documentation, and benefit continuation are determined by the applicable jurisdiction and plan.

An employee should provide notice as soon as reasonably possible. People Operations will identify the available leave category and may ask only for information reasonably needed to administer it.

LEV-6. Bereavement leave

Northstar provides:

- up to five paid scheduled workdays after the death of an immediate family or household member; and
- up to three paid scheduled workdays after the death of an extended family member or another person with a comparably close relationship.

"Family" is interpreted inclusively and is not limited to biological or legal relationships. Additional PTO or unpaid leave may be approved. Travel, cultural, religious, and administrative needs should be considered. Documentation is not routinely required, but People Operations may request reasonable confirmation where necessary.

LEV-7. Jury, witness, election, and civic duty

Northstar provides paid leave for up to 10 scheduled workdays per calendar year for required jury duty or comparable civic service, less any amount that local rules require the employee to remit. Longer service is handled according to law and may be paid or unpaid. An employee must provide the summons or notice and report any early release from service.

Voluntary political activity is not civic-duty leave and should normally use PTO or unpaid time. Employees must comply with **POL-CON-001** regarding political activity and use of company resources.

LEV-8. Personal unpaid leave

After 12 months of service, an employee may request a personal unpaid leave of up to 30 calendar days for a compelling reason not covered by another leave. Approval is discretionary and considers duration, operational coverage, prior leaves, performance, and whether a protected leave or accommodation applies.

A personal leave longer than 30 days requires VP and People Operations approval and may require a formal employment arrangement. Employees must not use personal unpaid leave to work for a competitor or avoid a conduct process.

LEV-9. Request and notification process

When foreseeable, leave should be requested at least 30 calendar days in advance or as soon as the need is known. For an emergency, the employee or representative should notify the manager or People Operations as soon as reasonably possible.

A request should identify the expected start date, estimated duration, whether the leave may be intermittent, and a safe contact method. The employee should not send detailed medical information to a manager or a general team channel.

LEV-10. Pay, PTO, accrual, and benefits

People Operations will provide a written summary of whether each portion of leave is paid, unpaid, covered by wellness leave, covered by PTO at the employee's election, or supported by a benefit program.

PTO accrues during paid leave. It may pause after 30 consecutive calendar days of unpaid leave unless law or a written approval requires continuation. Benefits continue according to **POL-BEN-001**, law, and plan terms. Employees may be responsible for their normal premium share during unpaid leave.

A company holiday during leave is paid only when required by the leave classification, plan, law, or written approval.

LEV-11. Communication and return to work

The employee must provide reasonable status updates and promptly report a changed return date. Managers should maintain appropriate, non-intrusive contact and must not pressure an employee to work during approved leave.

People Operations may request fitness-for-work or restriction information when lawful and job-related. Northstar will consider temporary restrictions, gradual return, schedule changes, and accommodation. An employee must not return to safety-sensitive duties contrary to a documented restriction.

LEV-12. Confidentiality and non-retaliation

Leave and medical information is Confidential and shared only as necessary for administration, safety, payroll, benefits, accommodation, or legal obligations. Employees will not be retaliated against for requesting or using leave in good faith, supporting another employee, or reporting a concern.

LEV-13. Misuse and corrections

Northstar may investigate material inconsistencies or suspected abuse, but a manager must consult People Operations before challenging medical or protected leave. Honest errors should be corrected. Intentional falsification may lead to corrective action.

LEV-14. Examples

- Three days of flu should normally be recorded as wellness leave, not vacation PTO, when the employee has available wellness hours.
- A planned parental leave should be raised at least 30 days in advance when possible, but late notice caused by an early birth does not eliminate legal rights.
- A five-day bereavement period for a household member is paid under this policy and should not be deducted from PTO.
- A six-week personal absence may require a combination of protected leave, unpaid leave, PTO, or a formal arrangement; it is not automatically approved as personal leave.

Related policies and records

- POL-PTO-001 - Paid Time Off and Vacation Policy
- POL-BEN-001 - Employee Benefits Eligibility
- POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation
- POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting